

Company: Oracle Financial Services Software

Job Profile: Associate Application Developer

Offer Type: Placement Only

CTC: 15.23 LPA (Annual Gross Pay)

Location: Mumbai , Bangalore, Pune or Chennai

Process Date: 15/09/25 (OA)

17/09/25 (Interview)

### Placement Process:

1 OA (Online)

1 Tech Interview (Offline)

1 Tech + HR (Offline)

1 HR(Offline)

1] **OA** [ No of candidates who appeared for this round : around 120 , shortlisting criteria : 7 CGPA and 70% in 10th and 12th]

So, our OA was actually supposed to be offline in college, but thanks to the rain it got shifted online at the last moment. The test was for 95 minutes.

It started off with 32 MCQs covering stuff like LLMs, Cloud, basic aptitude, api knowledge and some core tech subjects. There were also a few graph-related ones like articulation points and DFS traversal.

After that, there were 2 coding questions (everyone had different sets). Mine were:

1. We were given a list of requests, each having a user ID and a timestamp. The task was to decide whether each request should be allowed or not. A request could only be allowed if the user had made fewer than **k** requests in the last 1-minute window.

Example:

$n = 3$ , user = [1, 1, 1], timestamp = [6, 10, 65],  $k = 2$

Output  $\rightarrow$  [1, 1, 0]

2. Two interns had to complete  $n$  tasks. Out of these, the first intern had to do exactly **k** tasks and the second intern would do the rest. Each intern had rewards for every task, and we had to maximize the total reward.

Example:

$n = 5$ , reward\_1 = [5, 4, 3, 2, 1], reward\_2 = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5],  $k = 3$

Output  $\rightarrow$  21

**Tip from me:** Since you could navigate between questions, it's better to attempt the coding ones first (they weren't too hard) and then move on to MCQs. Completing both coding questions was super important to get shortlisted for interviews.

## **Only 25 students were shortlisted for interviews after OA.**

They had the PPT (pre-placement talk) only for the shortlisted candidates. It lasted for about 45 minutes and started at 10:15 AM. The company gave a brief introduction about what they do. My advice would be to pay close attention during the PPT, because it really helps when you want to ask relevant questions later.

After that, the interview rounds started at 11 AM.

It turned out to be a pretty tiring day for me because there was no fixed order for interviews. First, they collected our resumes, and then the interviewers just picked any resume randomly. Whoever's resume they picked was called in. I was eagerly waiting for my turn, but no luck. By that time, many students were already done with their 2nd round, and a few had even completed their 3rd and final interviews—while I hadn't even started my 1st round yet.

Still, I stayed calm, because I had faced a similar situation during my BlackRock interview. Back then, I was also one of the last ones to be interviewed, and even though I did well, I wasn't shortlisted for the next round. This time, I just kept my patience. Finally, I was the very last candidate called in for the 1st round, and my interview began around 3:45 PM.

### **2] 1st Technical Interview [25 students appeared for this round]**

There were 4 panels for Round 1. For me it was a cakewalk — mine lasted only about 10–15 minutes (I think being the last one actually helped). I heard other people's interviews went on for 30 minutes to an hour.

They started by asking me for a short intro and then jumped straight into four basic DSA questions: find the second-maximum element in an array, remove duplicates, check if a string is a palindrome, and write any recursive function (I wrote factorial and explained how recursion works). These were easy, but the interviewer was clearly testing how fast and clearly you think — they asked me to write pseudocode for each one. I finished the pseudocode in about 5–6 minutes.

After that they asked what my primary coding language was and whether I'd done development in Java. I was honest and said I hadn't. Then we moved on to REST APIs — I had to write a basic fetch request, explain query parameters and how they work, and discuss alternatives to query params. Finally they asked a basic SQL join syntax and that wrapped up my first interview.

I freaked out a little after because it was so short and I was last — many people were already on their 2nd or even 3rd rounds while I hadn't finished Round 1. But within 5 minutes they called me for Round 2, so I relaxed a bit.

**Tip:** Some students were grilled pretty hard on Java — things like file handling, inline functions, REST APIs, and Postman. A Postman question was *"How would you test two APIs where the output of one is the input of the other?"* — so make sure you can explain chaining API calls clearly. Also, those who had knowledge of Spring / Spring Boot were questioned in much more detail, so be thorough if you mention it on your resume. Some candidates were asked about MongoDB and were asked to write basic fetch and how to save on db queries and connections queries.

### 3] **2nd Tech+ HR** [15-16 candidates appeared for this round ]

This was the techno-HR round. Five minutes after I finished Round 1, I was called for Round 2 — this one was taken by one of the directors of OFSS (the same person who did the PPT), so paying attention during the talk actually helped. This round was totally resume-driven — no DSA, SQL, or puzzles.

The interviewer went through my resume and then we started with a short intro. He was super friendly and asked about my JEE journey, why I chose SPIT instead of an IIT/NIT, and why I went into engineering — those are open-ended, so be honest. He asked about my primary coding language and what made me pick it, then asked me to explain a recent project and drilled a few follow-ups. He also asked about my positions of responsibility — what my role was and how I balanced it with academics.

Since I'd been the marketing head, he gave me a Shark-Tank style task: imagine he was Jack Ma with 200 million to invest — pitch one of your crowdfunding projects and convince him to invest. At first I started explaining the project, then realized I needed to market it — so I switched to a pitch mode and that worked out well; the interviewer seemed happy.

He then asked some Java basics: what the import statement does, the difference between interfaces and abstraction (I gave examples), packages in Java, and to explain the static and final keywords. At the end he asked if I had any questions. From the PPT I remembered they mentioned AI models, so I asked whether Oracle (or the company) was building in-house AI models and how those models are affecting the company — I also asked his view on whether AI is a boon or a curse for people in tech. We wrapped up, shook hands, and I left. It lasted for around 35- 40 mins.

In my opinion this round was mainly to assess mindset, attitude toward tech, and confidence. My tip: be yourself, be confident, and know your resume inside out.

Only 9 students were shortlisted further.

### 4] **HR** [ 9 candidates appeared for this round ]

As soon as my 2nd round ended, I was called in for the 3rd and final round.

This one was more of a formality — the HR even mentioned it wasn't really an "interview," just a basic conversation. She asked me how my day had been so far, then a few simple things like my nationality and whether I was open to relocation. After that, she gave me a small situation-based question: *"Imagine you're a team lead and a conflict breaks out between two high-temper teammates — how would you handle it?"* I answered confidently about keeping calm, listening to both sides, and resolving it fairly. She seemed satisfied with my response and told me to wait for the results once everyone else was done.

After some time, when all the interviews wrapped up, they finally announced the results. Out of everyone, 9 students were offered the job — and I was one of them.

## Useful Resources I Followed :

- DSA: Regular practice on *LeetCode* and giving contests on *Codeforces* and *LeetCode*. This really helps with clearing the OA. I also referred to [Strivers A2Z DSA Course/Sheet](#) for structured prep.
- Aptitude: It's just as important as DSA, so don't ignore it. I prepared closer to the placement season using [Indiabix](#) and CodeHelp [Mock Test](#).
- SQL (Super Important): Practice in-depth because it's asked both in OA and interviews. I used [Leetcode](#) SQL problems. Make sure you cover:
  - [Last Minute Revision](#) (articles, cheat sheets, [Interview Questions](#))
  - DBMS + SQL [In depth](#)
  - Advanced SQL topics like window functions, triggers, procedures
- OOPS (VVIMP): Don't leave this for the last minute. [Learn in detail](#)
- OS (Can keep for last-minute but practice properly): [inDetail](#)  
Important topics → Paging, Threading, Semaphores. Notes are handy here too.
- CCN (Computer Networks, can also keep for last-minute): [CCN](#)  
Revise important concepts, practice a bit in detail.
- System Design: A few companies do ask for it. Practice some examples to be safe — YouTube [System Design](#) channels are helpful.
- **Most important resource for me was GFG ([GEEKSFORGEES](#))** — for last-minute preparation it helped me a lot.
- If your primary language is **Java**, then practice advanced topics in detail such as **synchronization, multithreading, exception handling, file handling, memory leaks, and implementation of various data structures in the Collection Framework.**

## Useful Tips:

- Communication skills and confidence are key and be you, be honest.
- Always take a pause and understand if the interviewer is keeping pace with you.
- Try hard, think out loud, ask for hints if you're stuck.
- If you need a minute to think or frame an answer, ask the interviewer for the same.
- Stay confident, a partially correct answer with 100% confidence is better than a fully correct answer with 50% confidence.
- Always give examples while explaining stuff wherever possible, preferably something relatable.
- Keep questions ready for the interviewer, they always ask if you have any questions for them, never say no here.
- Be attentive during the Pre-Placement Talk (PPT) as you'll get enough content to ask relevant questions.
- Your introduction should be short and to the point, and mention things you are good at as the interviewer may lead the discussion based on them.
- Be well versed with your resume from top to bottom.

- Don't just focus on DSA completely, make projects (do them yourself and try to participate in hackathons as winning is not important, the learning is) and have internship experience too.
- Always have a smile on your face and be interactive with your interviewer, even while solving something share your thought process.
- Interviewers are not just assessing your technical skills, they are also assessing your mindset and your approach.
- **Don't follow previous interview experiences blindly**, as those are from people who got selected but those who didn't may have had completely different experiences, so be confident in your strong points.

### My few previous experiences :

I was also selected for the JPMC CFG hackathon (a hiring hackathon), and since my hackathon experience went great, I was quite hopeful of converting it into an offer. Unfortunately, it didn't work out. I even skipped some companies because I was confident about CFG, but sometimes things don't go as planned.

Throughout the placement season, I cleared almost all the OAs for which I applied, but I was not able to convert them into a final selection. This placement phase really tested my patience to the extreme. Even after doing well in interviews, selections didn't happen. I gave interviews for JPMC Fintech, PhonePe, MSCI, IDFC, Nomura (GM role), BlackRock, EDS, and finally got selected at Oracle.

Every interview taught me something new. I don't consider these as failures, but rather as a learning process that helped me finally get selected.

- **MSCI interview:** I was asked to implement a max heap from scratch (which I managed to do), system design of WhatsApp/messaging system (with focus on group messaging), syntax of sharding in MongoDB (which I didn't know), and to write a Node.js server connection code. The lesson here: **always expect the unexpected.**
- **IDFC interview:** I was grilled deeply on Java, Spring Boot, and core implementations of data structures like Map and Set. I was also asked the detailed system design of a URL shortener (my mistake was not preparing system design properly even after being asked about it in MSCI). On top of this, I had to code on their compiler. I explained my code perfectly, but the compiler wasn't running it. The interviewer thought it was my mistake, and that shattered my confidence, leading me to make further errors. Later, I found out their compiler had an issue, and my code was correct all along. The learning: **be confident in what you know, and don't let external factors shake your confidence.**
- **EDS interviews:** Both rounds went pretty well. But in the last round, it came down to me and one other candidate. The other candidate was selected due to CGPA and their primary language being Python. Sometimes, despite a good performance, external factors can decide the outcome.

Through all these interviews, I lost my patience many times and even thought of giving up. Giving 100% each time and still not getting through was extremely stressful. But looking back, every rejection just made me stronger. I now believe that some things fall apart to make way for better ones. This was just the start of my career journey, and it has made me tougher for the future.

Placements are honestly based on luck to some extent, but if you don't give your 100%, even failures won't teach you anything. You need to be patient, learn from your failures, and put in more effort the next time. Not every day will be your day, but one day will surely be yours — and no one can take that from you. So always keep a smile, keep working hard, and stay strong.

**If you have doubts do not hesitate to contact me : [LinkedIn](#)**

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